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Class 4 English — CA-1 (Hard) — Answer Key

Class : 4

Subject : English (Santoor)

Max Marks : 70

Duration : 2 Hr 30 Min

Syllabus: Chapters 1–3 — Together We Can, The Tinkling Bells, Be Smart Be Safe

General Instructions: All questions are compulsory. For Section A, write the correct option letter.

ANSWER KEY

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1 Mark each)

1. Which best explains why "Together We Can" is written as a poem rather than a story, based on its purpose? (1 Mark)

A. Poems cannot convey any message

B. A poem's rhythm and concise language make an emotional, motivational message like teamwork more memorable and impactful ✓

C. It is simply the author's random choice with no reasoning

D. Stories are not allowed in English textbooks

2. In "The Tinkling Bells", what does Chinna's emotional reaction to losing the money suggest about the value he placed on it beyond its monetary worth? (1 Mark)

A. He did not care about the money at all

B. The money likely held sentimental value as a gift from his grandfather, beyond its simple monetary value ✓

C. He was only pretending to be upset

D. The story does not show any emotional reaction

3. Which statement best captures why "Be Smart, Be Safe" uses clear, repeated action steps (like "stop, look, cross") rather than general advice like "be careful"? (1 Mark)

A. General advice is always better for children

B. Specific, repeatable action steps are easier for young children to remember and correctly apply in real situations ✓

C. There is no difference between specific steps and general advice

D. Specific steps are harder to remember than general advice

4. How does the resolution of "The Tinkling Bells" (Kamala helping Chinna) compare thematically to the resolution suggested in "Together We Can" (achieving goals through teamwork)? (1 Mark)

A. They share no thematic connection

B. Both resolutions show that connecting with others and offering/receiving support leads to positive outcomes ✓

C. One is about failure and the other about success, with no connection

D. The two chapters contradict each other

5. What is the most likely reason the unit places "Together We Can" (teamwork) before "The Tinkling Bells" (individual kindness) and "Be Smart, Be Safe" (personal safety)? (1 Mark)

A. The order is random and has no purpose

B. It may introduce the broad value of supporting others before narrowing to specific examples of kindness and then self-care ✓

C. Personal safety is the least important lesson, so it comes last

D. There is no logical reason for chapter order in any textbook

6. Which best explains why "Be Smart, Be Safe" likely avoids overly technical or complicated traffic rules? (1 Mark)

A. Technical rules are more important for children to know

B. Simple, practical rules are more appropriate and memorable for the target age group of the chapter ✓

C. The chapter includes only technical rules

D. There is no reason for this choice

7. If a reader focused only on the plot of "The Tinkling Bells" (losing and then getting money/bells) without considering character actions, what deeper lesson might they miss? (1 Mark)

A. Nothing would be missed

B. They might miss the deeper lesson about empathy, kindness, and the value of supportive friendship shown through Kamala's actions ✓

C. The plot is the only important part of the story

D. There is no deeper lesson in the story

8. Which of these best describes how "Together We Can" and "Be Smart, Be Safe" differ in their approach to teaching a lesson? (1 Mark)

A. Both use identical teaching approaches

B. "Together We Can" uses emotional, poetic inspiration, while "Be Smart, Be Safe" uses direct, practical instruction ✓

C. Neither chapter teaches any lesson

D. "Be Smart, Be Safe" is also written as a poem

9. Which best explains why the story "The Tinkling Bells" specifically involves a grandfather's gift, rather than money Chinna earned himself? (1 Mark)

A. It has no particular significance

B. A gift from a grandparent likely carries extra emotional and sentimental weight, deepening the impact of the loss and the relief when it is resolved ✓

C. Grandparents are not important in the story

D. The detail is irrelevant to the plot

SECTION B — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks each)

1. Analyse how the poem "Together We Can" might influence a reader's behaviour differently from a story like "The Tinkling Bells", considering their different literary formats. (0 Marks)
 - As a poem, "Together We Can" is likely to inspire an emotional, motivational response through its rhythm and concise, memorable language, encouraging a general attitude of teamwork, while "The Tinkling Bells", as a narrative story, provides a specific, relatable scenario that can more directly model a particular helpful behaviour (comforting a friend) for readers to imitate in similar real-life situations.
2. Critically discuss whether the resolution in "The Tinkling Bells" (Kamala buying the bells) might unintentionally suggest that problems are solved simply by replacing what was lost, rather than addressing the emotional loss itself. (0 Marks)
 - While the practical resolution of getting new bells is the visible outcome, the story's true emphasis appears to be on the emotional support and comfort Kamala provides first, suggesting the deeper lesson is about the value of empathy and friendship, not just a simple material replacement of the lost item.
3. Explain why repeated safety instructions (like checking right-left-right) might be more effective than a single check, from both a psychological and practical standpoint. (0 Marks)
 - Psychologically, repetition reinforces habit formation, making the safety check more automatic over time; practically, checking multiple times (especially right twice) accounts for the possibility of a vehicle appearing in the time it takes to look across all directions, reducing the risk of missing an approaching vehicle.
4. Discuss how the value of "trust" mentioned in "Together We Can" might be tested or demonstrated in a real conflict situation, beyond the simple, positive scenario shown in the poem. (0 Marks)
 - In a real conflict, such as a disagreement during a group project, trust would be tested by whether team members continue to support and communicate honestly with each other despite differing opinions, showing that true trust involves working through difficulties, not just enjoying success together as shown in the poem's simpler scenario.
5. Evaluate whether "Be Smart, Be Safe" adequately prepares children for real-world road situations that may be more complex than the idealised examples given (like an empty road with a clear zebra crossing). (0 Marks)
 - While the chapter provides a strong foundational framework, real-world situations - such as roads without clear zebra crossings, heavy traffic, or aggressive drivers - are more complex than the idealised examples typically given, suggesting that these lessons need to be reinforced with ongoing supervised practice in real environments, not just textbook learning alone.
6. Analyse the narrative structure of "The Tinkling Bells" (problem, emotional low point, resolution) and discuss why this structure is commonly used in children's literature. (0 Marks)
 - This structure - introducing a relatable problem, showing an emotional low point, and then providing a hopeful resolution - is commonly used in children's literature because it mirrors real emotional experiences in a manageable way, teaching children that difficulties can be overcome, while also holding their attention through a clear, satisfying story arc.
7. Discuss how the message of "Together We Can" might need to be balanced with lessons about independence and individual responsibility (as touched on in "Be Smart, Be Safe"). (0 Marks)
 - While "Together We Can" emphasises the value of teamwork and mutual support, "Be Smart, Be Safe" emphasises individual awareness and responsibility (like personally checking for traffic); balancing both lessons teaches children that while community and support are valuable, personal responsibility and independent judgment are equally necessary, especially in situations like road safety where relying solely on others could be dangerous.
8. Explain how a reader's own past experiences (such as having a supportive friend or a road safety scare) might change how deeply they connect with these three chapters compared to a reader without such experiences. (0 Marks)
 - A reader who has experienced a similar situation - like receiving comfort from a friend during a hard time, or having a close call while crossing a road - is likely to connect more deeply and emotionally with these chapters, since they can directly relate the story's events to their own memories, whereas a reader without such experiences might understand the lessons more abstractly, without the same personal emotional connection.
9. Discuss why "Be Smart, Be Safe" is placed within a broader unit that also emphasises kindness and teamwork, rather than being taught as a completely separate, isolated safety lesson. (0 Marks)
 - Placing safety education alongside lessons on kindness and teamwork may help children see safety not just as a set of rules to follow alone, but as something connected to caring for oneself and others - for example, reminding a friend to be safe is an act of care, similar to the kindness shown in "The Tinkling Bells", showing how these values can reinforce each other rather than existing in isolation.
10. Critically assess whether poems like "Together We Can" risk oversimplifying complex social values like teamwork for young readers, and discuss whether this simplification is appropriate for the intended age group. (0 Marks)
 - While the poem does simplify teamwork into an idealised, positive message without addressing challenges like disagreement or unequal contribution, this simplification is likely appropriate for the intended young age group, as it introduces the core positive value first, with more nuanced understanding expected to develop naturally as children grow and encounter more complex real-world team situations in later years.
11. Explain how "The Tinkling Bells" might have been different if Chinna had been alone with no friend like Kamala nearby, and discuss what this hypothetical reveals about the story's underlying message. (0 Marks)
 - Without Kamala, Chinna would likely have remained upset with no immediate solution, possibly needing to find another way to cope or explain the situation to his grandfather alone; this hypothetical reveals that the story's underlying message centres specifically on the value that a caring friend or community adds during difficult moments, rather than suggesting problems always resolve on their own.
12. Discuss how the concept of "smart" in the chapter title "Be Smart, Be Safe" might mean more than just following rules, and explain what additional qualities this term could imply. (0 Marks)
 - "Smart" in this context likely implies not just blindly following rules, but actively thinking, observing, and making good judgments in the moment - such as noticing an approaching vehicle even if not expected - suggesting that true safety requires active awareness and critical thinking, not just passive rule-following.

13. Analyse why the poem "Together We Can" uses inclusive language like "we" throughout, rather than focusing on an individual "I" perspective. (0 Marks)

- Using "we" throughout reinforces the poem's central theme of collective effort and unity, making the reader feel part of a group rather than an isolated individual, which strengthens the emotional impact of the message about teamwork and shared success.

14. Discuss whether learning about road safety through a narrative or activity-based approach (rather than just rules) might be more effective for long-term retention in children, referencing general principles of learning. (0 Marks)

- Narrative or activity-based learning often creates stronger emotional and contextual connections in memory compared to simply memorising a list of rules, meaning that combining road safety rules with relatable stories or hands-on practice (like role-playing crossing a road) would likely lead to better long-term retention and application of these safety lessons in real life.

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (Explain) (3 Marks each)

1. Critically analyse how all three chapters (Together We Can, The Tinkling Bells, Be Smart Be Safe) use different literary formats (poem, narrative story, instructional text) to teach related but distinct values, and discuss the effectiveness of this varied approach. (0 Marks)

- "Together We Can", as a poem, uses emotional and rhythmic language to inspire a general, motivational attitude toward teamwork and trust.
- "The Tinkling Bells", as a narrative story, uses a relatable plot and characters to model a specific act of kindness and its positive impact, allowing readers to see the lesson in action through relatable events.
- "Be Smart, Be Safe", as an instructional text, uses direct, practical steps to teach a concrete, actionable skill (road safety) that requires precise behaviour rather than emotional inspiration alone.
- This varied approach is effective because it exposes young readers to different ways of learning - emotional inspiration, narrative modelling, and direct instruction - catering to different learning styles and reinforcing that lessons can be conveyed through many different forms of writing.

2. Evaluate the claim that "kindness" (as shown in The Tinkling Bells) and "safety awareness" (as shown in Be Smart, Be Safe) are fundamentally different types of lessons, or whether they share a deeper common foundation. (0 Marks)

- On the surface, kindness involves caring for others' emotions, while safety awareness involves caring for physical wellbeing, which might suggest they are quite different types of lessons.
- However, a deeper look reveals both are rooted in the same foundation of awareness and care - kindness requires being aware of others' emotional states, while safety requires being aware of one's physical surroundings.
- This suggests that both lessons, despite their different surface focus, share a common foundation of attentiveness and care, whether directed outward toward others (kindness) or applied to oneself and one's surroundings (safety).

3. Discuss how a teacher might use all three chapters together in a single project or activity to reinforce their combined lessons, and explain why an integrated approach might be more powerful than teaching each chapter separately. (0 Marks)

- A teacher could design a "community helpers" project where students role-play scenarios combining teamwork (working in pairs), kindness (helping a friend in a mock difficult situation), and safety (safely navigating a mock road crossing) within a single classroom activity.
- An integrated approach allows children to see how these values connect and interact in real life, rather than treating them as entirely separate lessons only relevant to their specific chapter.
- This integrated understanding is likely more powerful because real life rarely separates values into neat categories - a single real situation, like walking home from school with a friend, might require teamwork, kindness, and safety awareness all at once, just as an integrated lesson would demonstrate.

4. Analyse how the emotional arc of "The Tinkling Bells" (from distress to relief) might be intentionally designed to teach emotional regulation skills to young readers, beyond just the lesson about friendship. (0 Marks)

- The story's structure - showing Chinna's initial distress, followed by comfort, and finally relief - provides young readers with a model for how difficult emotions can be processed and resolved over time, rather than remaining overwhelming forever.
- By seeing a character experience and move through an upsetting emotion with the help of a friend, readers may indirectly learn that expressing feelings and seeking support are healthy, effective ways to manage distress.
- This suggests the story teaches emotional regulation skills alongside its more obvious lesson about friendship, showing how children's literature can convey multiple layers of learning within a single, simple narrative.

5. Critically discuss whether the safety instructions in "Be Smart, Be Safe" sufficiently address the responsibility of drivers and adults, or whether they place too much responsibility solely on children as pedestrians. (0 Marks)

- The chapter's focus appears to be primarily on what children themselves can control - their own behaviour when walking or crossing roads - which is a practical and empowering approach for a children's textbook.
- However, this focus might understate the shared responsibility of drivers and adults in ensuring road safety, since even a perfectly careful child pedestrian can still be at risk from careless drivers.
- A more complete road safety education might also include lessons on advocating for safer road environments or understanding that safety is a shared responsibility between pedestrians, drivers, and infrastructure, rather than resting solely on the child's careful behaviour.

6. Discuss how the progression from "Together We Can" (broad value) to "The Tinkling Bells" (specific example) to "Be Smart, Be Safe" (practical skill) might reflect a deliberate pedagogical strategy in how this unit is structured. (0 Marks)

- Starting with "Together We Can" introduces a broad, inspiring value (teamwork and trust) in an emotionally engaging way through poetry, setting a positive tone for the unit.
- "The Tinkling Bells" narrows this broad value into a specific, relatable example of kindness in action, helping students see how the abstract value plays out in a concrete situation.
- "Be Smart, Be Safe" then shifts to a very practical, actionable skill, showing that the unit moves from inspiration, to relatable example, to direct practical application - a deliberate pedagogical strategy that helps students both feel inspired and gain concrete, useful skills by the end of the unit.

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (5 Marks each)

1. Write a comprehensive essay analysing how "Together We Can", "The Tinkling Bells", and "Be Smart, Be Safe" together build a progressive understanding of care - from broad teamwork, to specific personal kindness, to practical self-protection - and discuss why this progression might be intentionally designed for Class 4 students. (0 Marks)

- "Together We Can" begins the unit with a broad, emotionally engaging message about teamwork and trust, delivered through poetry, establishing a positive foundation about the value of supporting others.
- "The Tinkling Bells" narrows this broad theme into a specific, relatable story of personal kindness, showing exactly how supporting a friend in a moment of need can make a meaningful difference, giving students a concrete model to relate to and imitate.
- "Be Smart, Be Safe" then shifts focus to practical self-protection, teaching direct, actionable safety steps that protect the individual child, rounding out the unit with a skill-based, practical lesson.
- This progression - from broad inspiration, to specific relatable example, to practical skill - reflects a deliberate and effective pedagogical structure for Class 4 students, who are at an age where they can grasp emotional and social lessons while also needing concrete, practical guidance for real-world situations like road safety; this structure ensures the unit is both emotionally meaningful and practically useful.

2. Design a school assembly presentation for younger students, drawing lessons from all three chapters (Together We Can, The Tinkling Bells, Be Smart Be Safe). Describe the structure, key messages, and any activities you would include, explaining how each part connects to the chapters studied. (0 Marks)

- This is a creative, open-ended design task; there is no single correct answer, but strong responses should thoughtfully incorporate all three chapters' themes.
- A strong answer might structure the assembly in three parts: an opening song or poem recitation inspired by "Together We Can" to set a positive, united tone; a short skit reenacting a scenario like "The Tinkling Bells" to demonstrate kindness in action; and an interactive safety demonstration (like a mock zebra crossing) based on "Be Smart, Be Safe" to actively teach practical safety steps.
- The explanation should clearly connect each part of the presentation back to the specific themes and lessons from the three chapters, showing a thoughtful, well-structured integration of teamwork, kindness, and safety for a younger audience.

3. Reflect deeply on how the combined lessons of teamwork, kindness, and safety from this unit might shape the kind of person you want to become. Write a thoughtful, detailed essay connecting these values to your own goals and future behaviour. (0 Marks)

- This is a personal, open-ended reflective essay, and there is no single correct answer.
- A strong response should thoughtfully discuss how each of the three values - teamwork (Together We Can), kindness (The Tinkling Bells), and safety awareness (Be Smart, Be Safe) - resonates with the student's own goals or self-image.
- The essay should include specific, genuine examples of how the student might apply these values in their own life, such as being a more supportive friend, noticing when someone needs help, or being more careful and aware near roads, showing a mature and thoughtful connection between the unit's lessons and the student's personal growth.